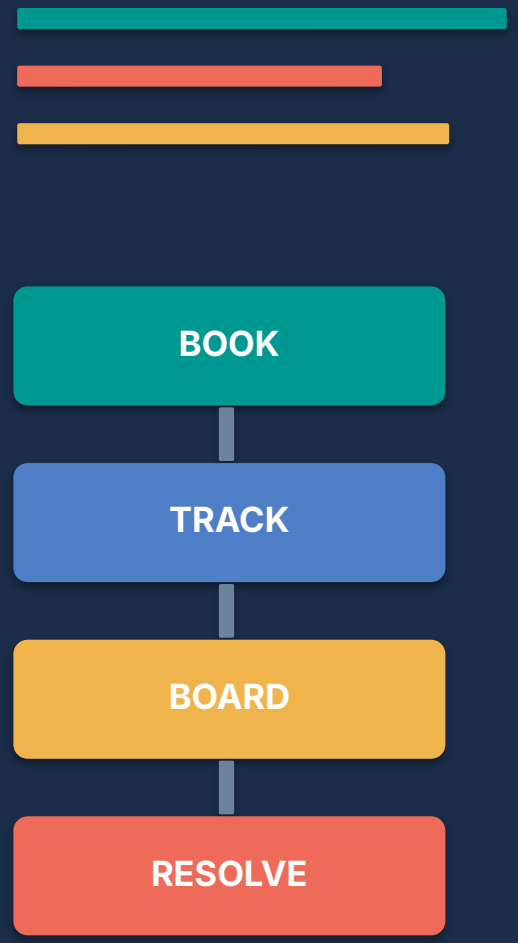
FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER / CANDIDATE ASSIGNMENT

Fix the commute. Earn the rating.

A review-led plan to improve MoveInSync's employee journey on Google Play.

Prepared by Nilanshu Kumar Singh

Evidence base: public Play Store listings and visible reviews (Oct 2026) + assignment brief



13 OCT 2026 • Recommendations are hypotheses until validated with product telemetry

The rating problem is a journey-reliability problem

The public listing is already rated 4.6/5 (~1.15 lakh ratings, listing checked Oct 2026); the opportunity is to prevent avoidable bad commute experiences.

4.6 / 5
Headline rating shown

1.15 lakh
Reviews shown on listing

3
Commute-critical P0 bets

NORTH STAR

A booked ride should feel booked.

WHAT REVIEWERS VALUE

- Convenient office commute and one place for ride information
- Live vehicle tracking and useful trip alerts when they work
- Professional drivers, comfortable rides, and helpful support in positive reviews

WHAT BREAKS TRUST

- Booking state is unclear; users can leave believing a ride is booked
- Stale GPS / inaccurate ETA and missing or delayed notifications
- Surprise no-shows, app loading/crashes, and unclear issue ownership

Recommendation: fix the commute-critical failures before optimizing rating prompts.

How to read each star band

A reading framework for severity and strengths. Not measured evidence, and not representative of the whole user base.

1★ Broken journey

Booking fails or is ambiguous; tracking and app reliability can disrupt a time-critical commute.

2★ Works, with friction

Core use case has value, but navigation, loading, location edits, notifications, or recovery can be painful.

3★ Useful, not effortless

Users often see the utility but ask for more predictable workflows, clearer information, and fewer limitations.

4★ Positive with asks

Convenience and core functionality are appreciated; common asks include maps, reminders, booking flexibility, and messaging.

5★ Value delivered

Praise centers on simplified commute, accurate tracking when it works, smooth booking, driver behavior, and convenience.

Interpretation: high overall satisfaction can coexist with a small number of high-impact failures—especially when a missed ride affects work attendance.

Method note: star labels were not preserved on the review text I collected, so these bands are a reading framework, not measured results. No percentages are claimed.

Six themes repeatedly connect to the employee journey

Examples below are paraphrases of visible public reviews; they are qualitative signals, not prevalence estimates.

01 Booking clarity

A user thought a cab was booked after the UI changed, then discovered no booking existed.

BOOK

02 GPS & ETA trust

Reviews describe stale vehicle location, wrong pickup/drop estimates, map behavior, and missing rider locations.

TRACK

03 No-show & cancellation

Users report surprise no-show outcomes, accidental cancellation risk, and requests for pickup/check-in reminders.

BOARD

04 App reliability

Slow loads, crashes, repeated login/OTP issues, and reinstall workarounds interrupt urgent tasks.

ACCESS

05 Notifications & coordination

Late/missing alerts, excessive pop-ups, and requests for clearer driver/rider coordination appear.

ALERT

06 Support & configuration

Some problems may depend on employer policies or transport operations; users need a visible owner and status.

RESOLVE

Scope boundary: separate app defects from employer policy, transport planning, and driver operations before assigning engineering ownership.

Prioritize failures that can make an employee miss a ride

A practical backlog for Product, Engineering, Operations, and the FDE—not a feature wishlist.

P0 / FIRST

Booking certainty

Booked / Pending / Not booked status, trip details, safe retry. Owner: Product + Android.

Tracking truth

Show last GPS update; track stale pings and ETA error. Owner: Engineering.

No-show fairness

Pickup reminder, check-in state, dispute path. Owner: Product + Ops.

P1 / NEXT

Stability & access

Fix crashes, long loads, OTP/login loops, and reinstall-required failures.

Notification quality

Prioritize actionable trip alerts; remove duplicate or blocking pop-ups.

Issue ownership

In-app ticket receipt, category routing, status, SLA, and closure message.

P2 / VALIDATE

Location flexibility

Make pickup/drop edits and policy limits explicit before booking.

Coordination

Evaluate secure driver messaging/calling within employer safety policies.

Rating experience

Use neutral, capped review prompts only after a successful journey.

Turn review themes into a 30-day operating loop

Start with evidence and instrumentation; ship narrow fixes; then verify that the real journey improved.

DAYS 1–3

Baseline & triage

- Capture rating/review-count snapshot and collect a reproducible recent review sample.
- Tag reviews by theme, severity, app version if known, and likely owner.
- Pair review signals with booking, GPS, notification, crash, and support data.

DAYS 4–7

Reproduce & scope

- Replay booking-state and stale-GPS issues with QA and Operations.
- Map no-show triggers, cancellation cut-offs, and employer-specific policy boundaries.
- Create owner-assigned issues with acceptance criteria and baseline metrics.

WEEK 2

Ship small fixes

- Improve booking status and retry safety; expose GPS freshness.
- Add a no-show reminder/dispute prototype behind a controlled rollout.
- Add ticket receipt/status and trim duplicate or blocking notifications.

WEEKS 3–4

Measure & iterate

- Release to a limited cohort; compare before/after by app version and trip cohort.
- Read new 1–2★ and 4–5★ samples; manually audit the theme classifier.
- Scale fixes that improve operational KPIs without harming safety or usability.

Operating rule: no target percentages until a clean baseline exists; set targets with Product, Ops, and Engineering after week one.

Measure the commute—not just the stars

Ratings are a lagging signal. Pair them with leading operational metrics so teams can see whether the experience actually improved.

BOOKING	Completion rate • duplicate/ambiguous booking rate
TRACKING	GPS freshness P50/P90 • pickup ETA absolute error
NO-SHOW	Disputed no-shows per 1,000 trips • false no-show rate
RELIABILITY	Crash-free sessions • p95 app load time • OTP success
NOTIFICATIONS	Delivery latency • failed/dismissed alert rate
SUPPORT	Time to owner • first response • resolution • repeat issue rate

Rating scorecard: rolling 30-day average • 1–2★ share • themes by star band • review response time • version-level trend

Make “How are our ratings?” a weekly answer, not a one-off deck

The assignment explicitly says this question will recur. Build a lightweight review-intelligence loop that produces evidence and owners.

1

COLLECT

Store snapshot + recent written reviews; record date, app, language, and available star metadata.

2

CLASSIFY

Tag booking, GPS/ETA, no-show, reliability, notifications, support, policy, safety, positive, other.

3

VALIDATE

Manually check a sample; separate app defects from employer/operations constraints; avoid unsupported percentages.

4

ACT

Create issues with owner, severity, evidence, acceptance criteria, and KPI; link repeated reports.

5

RECHECK

Compare the next review window and operational metrics; update priorities and release notes.

OUTPUT EACH WEEK

A short Markdown/CSV report • top emerging themes • sample evidence • open issues and owners • rating + operational KPI trend

Built: review_monitor.py (Python, google-play-scraper + pandas) is in the repo; weekly summary, trend, themes, worst app versions. Check source terms before scheduling.

Fix trust at the moments that matter.

Booking confirmation → reliable pickup information → fair check-in → visible resolution.

METHOD & TOOLS

- Read the assignment brief and FDE job description.
- Reviewed the public Google Play listings and visible review text that I collected (Oct 2026).
- Used structured qualitative coding and AI-assisted synthesis; recommendations remain hypotheses.

LIMITATIONS

- Review samples are self-selected and not representative by default.
- Star labels were not preserved on collected text; no bucket percentages are claimed.
- No internal telemetry. Scope is the employee app; driver apps (Driver Partner 3.5, Partner Lite 4.2) are a follow-up track.

Success = fewer failed or confusing trips, not simply more positive prompts.